Accessibility Audit

Before Accessibility Fixes

Light House

Issues to Improve

- Contrast Ratio
  - The main color and text color do not meet the minimum contrast ratio, which creates difficulty for users with low or impaired vision. The WCAG contrast ratio requirements are 4.5:1 for normal text and 3:1 for large text, which the site didn't meet either. To fix this issue, I will deepen the main color's tone.
- Audio and Image size
  - The large file sizes for images and audio cause a slower page load, which impacts users with slower connections for their devices. To fix this issue, I will compress all images and audio files.
- Empty Links
  - Screen readers are unable to recognize the icon links and would instead announce them as empty links. The WCAG states that links must include link text for these screen readers. This is important for users with visual impairments who rely on a screen reader. To fix these issues, I will add Aria-label and Aria-hidden to the empty links.
- Heading Structure
  - There are multiple uses of the H1 tag and a skip in an H2 and an H4 tag, creating a non-sequential order. According to the WCAG, headings should follow a sequential descending order of H1 to H6 to help screen readers navigate the site in order. This is necessary for users with visual impairments who rely on a screen reader. To fix this issue, I will change all but one H1 tag to H2, then the rest to H2 in descending order.
- Missing meta description.

- Meta descriptions help search engines find and understand a page's content better; however, it isn't a direct accessibility issue. To fix this issue, I will add a meta description to the head tag of the code.

Performance

INSIGHTS

- ▲ Improve image delivery — Est savings of 2,039 KiB
- ▲ Font display — Est savings of 270 ms
- ▲ Render blocking requests — Est savings of 80 ms
- ▲ LCP request discovery
- ▲ Network dependency tree
- ■ Use efficient cache lifetimes — Est savings of 83 KiB
- ■ Document request latency — Est savings of 11 KiB

Accessiblity

CONTRAST

- ▲ Background and foreground colors do not have a sufficient contrast ratio.

These are opportunities to improve the legibility of your content.

NAMES AND LABELS

- ▲ Links do not have a discernible name

These are opportunities to improve the semantics of the controls in your application. This may enhance the experience for users of assistive technology, like a screen reader.

NAVIGATION

- ▲ Heading elements are not in a sequentially-descending order

These are opportunities to improve keyboard navigation in your application.

Best Practices

GENERAL

- Uses third-party cookies — 29 cookies found
- Issues were logged in the `Issues` panel in Chrome Devtools

SEO

CONTENT BEST PRACTICES

- Document does not have a meta description

Format your HTML in a way that enables crawlers to better understand your app's content.

Wave

13	22	10
Errors	Contrast Errors	Alerts
4	29	0
Features	Structure	ARIA

AIM Score: 3.4 out of 10

Errors & Contrast Errors

13 Errors

1 Empty form label

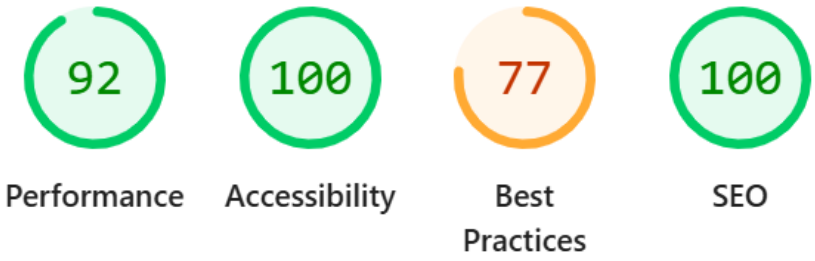
12 Empty link

22 Contrast Errors

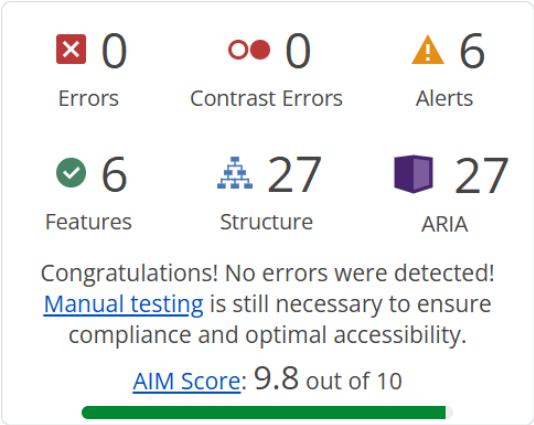
22 Very low contrast

After Accessibility Fixes

Light House



Wave



Fixes Implemented

- Changed the main color to a dark tone to improve the contrast ratio with the text color to boost accessibility.
    - Before

```
/* ================================
    CSS VARIABLES
   ================================ */
:root {
   /* Brand Color */
   --main-color: #3D9EFF;
   --main-color-dark: #1687f9;
   --secondary-color: #ff6978;
   --third-color: #b943a8;
   --fourth-color: #766ed3;
   --color-black: #000;
   --color-white: #fff;
   --color-text-muted: #999999;
```

- After

```
/* ================================
    CSS VARIABLES
   ================================ */
:root {
   /* Brand Color */
   --main-color: #0057ad;
   --main-color-dark: #00458b;
   --secondary-color: #ff6978;
   --third-color: #b943a8;
   --fourth-color: #625ab4;
   --color-black: #000;
   --color-white: #fff;
   --color-text-muted: #999999;
```

- Compressed audio and image files to boost performance
- Remove the extra font, Imbue, from Google link
  - Before

```
<!-- Google Fonts -->
<link rel="preconnect" href="https://fonts.googleapis.com">
<link rel="preconnect" href="https://fonts.gstatic.com" crossorigin>
<link
    href="https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?family=Freeman&family=Imbue:opsz,wght@10..100,100..900&family=Notable&display=swap"
    rel="stylesheet">
```

  - After

```html
<!-- Google Fonts -->
<link rel="preconnect" href="https://fonts.googleapis.com">
<link rel="preconnect" href="https://fonts.gstatic.com" crossorigin>
<link
    href="https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?family=Freeman&family=Notable&display=swap"
    rel="stylesheet">
```

- Add Aria-label and Aria-hidden to fix empty links.
    - Before

```html
<!-- New Music Item 2 -->
<div class="new-music-box">
    <div class="album-wrapper">
        <img src="assets/images/ChoosinTexas-AlbumCover.png" alt="Choosing Texas Album Cover"
            class="new-music-image">
    </div>
    <h2 class="new-music-box-title">Choosin' Texas</h2>
    <p class="new-music-box-description">Ella Langley | Oct 17, 2025</p>
    <div class="icon-wrapper">
        <a href="https://open.spotify.com/track/65DbTqJKhbwqYbZ1Okr0rc?si=8b294a2ccf584137"
            class="icon-link"><i class="fa-brands fa-spotify"></i></a>
        <a href="https://music.apple.com/us/album/choosin-texas-single/1844932149"
            class="icon-link"><i class="fa-brands fa-itunes"></i></a>
        <a href="https://soundcloud.com/ellalangley/choosin-texas?utm_source=clipboard&utm_medium=text&utm_campaign=social_sharing"
            class="icon-link"><i class="fa-brands fa-soundcloud"></i></a>
        <a href="https://www.pandora.com/artist/ella-langley/choosin-texas/choosin-texas/TRwjcZjXKx5Vcj6?part=ug-desktop&corr=88985677206687913"
            class="icon-link"><i class="fa-brands fa-pandora"></i></a>
    </div>
</div>
```

- After

```html
<!-- New Music Item 2 -->
<div class="new-music-box">
    <div class="album-wrapper">
        <img src="assets/images/ChoosinTexas-AlbumCover.png" alt="Choosing Texas Album Cover"
            class="new-music-image">
    </div>
    <h2 class="new-music-box-title">Choosin' Texas</h2>
    <p class="new-music-box-description">Ella Langley | Oct 17, 2025</p>
    <div class="icon-wrapper">
        <a href="https://open.spotify.com/track/65DbTqJKhbwqYbZ1Okr0rc?si=8b294a2ccf584137"
            class="icon-link" aria-label="Listen to Choosing Texas on Spotify"><i class="fa-brands fa-spotify" aria-hidden="true"></i></a>
        <a href="https://music.apple.com/us/album/choosin-texas-single/1844932149"
            class="icon-link" aria-label="Listen to Choosing Texas on Apple Music"><i class="fa-brands fa-itunes" aria-hidden="true"></i></a>
        <a href="https://soundcloud.com/ellalangley/choosin-texas?utm_source=clipboard&utm_medium=text&utm_campaign=social_sharing"
            class="icon-link" aria-label="Listen to Choosing Texas on SoundCloud"><i class="fa-brands fa-soundcloud" aria-hidden="true"></i></a>
        <a href="https://www.pandora.com/artist/ella-langley/choosin-texas/choosin-texas/TRwjcZjXKx5Vcj6?part=ug-desktop&corr=88985677206687913"
            class="icon-link" aria-label="Listen to Choosing Texas on Pandora"><i class="fa-brands fa-pandora" aria-hidden="true"></i></a>
    </div>
</div>
```

- Changed heading structure by using only one H1, and the rest moved down.
    - Before

```html
<!-- SOUNDBOARD SECTION-->
<aside id="soundboard" class="soundboard-section">
    <h1 class="soundboard-header">Soundboard</h1>
    <div class="soundboard-content">
        <!-- Soundboard Item 1 -->
        <div class="soundboard-box">
            <audio controls class="soundboard-audio">
                <source src="assets/audios/lewis-capaldi-audio-podcast.mp3" type="audio/mpeg">
                <!-- Source: https://www.npr.org/2025/11/18/nx-s1-5585079/lewis-capaldi-the-day-that-i-die-survive-ep -->
            </audio>
            <h3 class="soundboard-box-title">Lewis Capaldi on healing, humor and his new EP</h3>
            <p class="soundboard-box-description">Adam Bearne & Leila Fadel | Nov 19, 2025</p>
        </div>
```

- After

```html
<!-- SOUNDBOARD SECTION-->
<aside id="soundboard" class="soundboard-section">
    <h2 class="soundboard-header">Soundboard</h2>
    <div class="soundboard-content">
        <!-- Soundboard Item 1 -->
        <div class="soundboard-box">
            <audio controls class="soundboard-audio">
                <source src="assets/audios/lewis-capaldi-audio-podcast.mp3" type="audio/mpeg">
                <!-- Source: https://www.npr.org/2025/11/18/nx-s1-5585079/lewis-capaldi-the-day-that-i-die-survive-ep -->
            </audio>
            <h3 class="soundboard-box-title">Lewis Capaldi on healing, humor and his new EP</h3>
            <p class="soundboard-box-description">Adam Bearne & Leila Fadel | Nov 19, 2025</p>
        </div>
```

- Added SEO Meta tags
  - Before

```html
    <head>
        <meta charset="UTF-8">
        <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
        <title>Forte - Music Journalism</title>
        <!-- Google Fonts -->
        <link rel="preconnect" href="https://fonts.googleapis.com">
        <link rel="preconnect" href="https://fonts.gstatic.com" crossorigin>
        <link
            href="https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?family=Freeman&family=Imbue:opsz,wght@10..100,100..900&family=Notable&display=swap"
            rel="stylesheet">
        <!-- ICONS -->
        <link rel="stylesheet" href="https://cdnjs.cloudflare.com/ajax/libs/font-awesome/7.0.1/css/all.min.css"
            integrity="sha512-2SwdPD6INVrV/lHTZbO2nodKhrnDdJK9/kg2XD1r9uGqPo1cUbujc+IYdlYdEErWNu69gVcYgdxlmVmzTWnetw=="
            crossorigin="anonymous" referrerpolicy="no-referrer" />
        <!-- CSS LINK -->
        <link rel="stylesheet" href="style.css">
    </head>
```

  - After

```html
<head>
    <meta charset="UTF-8">
    <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
    <title>Forte - Music Journalism</title>

    <!-- SEO META TAGS -->
    <meta name="description"
        content="Forte is a creative digital magazine that follows everything regarding music. From Interviews, Podcasts, Articles, and new music, this site provides a comprehensive catalog for music lovers.">
    <meta name="keywords" content="music, journalism, interviews, podcasts, articles, new music">
    <meta name="author" content="Forte - Music Journalism">

    <!-- Google Fonts -->
    <link rel="preconnect" href="https://fonts.googleapis.com">
    <link rel="preconnect" href="https://fonts.gstatic.com" crossorigin>
    <link
        href="https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?family=Freeman&family=Notable&display=swap"
        rel="stylesheet">
```

Reflection

I was most surprised by how much the site's performance improved after compressing the images and audio files. It seemed like such a small change, but it greatly impacted the overall site. I was also surprised that removing the extra font slightly boosted performance. It shows that including unnecessary tags and information on your web page will slow down the site because it loads more information than it needs. Changing the heading structure of the entire page was the most challenging and tedious part. This reminds me to be more careful and considerate of my users when designing and coding. Actively fixing these accessibility issues also helps me become a better UX designer, as I should take these necessary considerations into account for our users.